

Ξενοκράτης ὁ Χαλκηδόνιος

Xenocrates of Chalcedon and the Platonic School

eul_aid: hda

Period: Κλασική Classical
Dialect: Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική Attic Philosophical
Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy
Format: Πραγματεία Treatise
Affiliation: Platonist

Xenocrates of Chalcedon was a Greek philosopher of the 4th century BCE, living from approximately 396 to 314 BCE. He moved to Athens as a young man and became a student of Plato. After Plato's death, he studied under Speusippus, and in 339 BCE he was elected the third head, or scholarch, of Plato's Academy, a position he held for 25 years.

Ancient sources describe him as a man of austere and unwavering moral character. He was a prolific writer, but none of his works survive complete. They are known only through titles and fragments quoted by later authors. His many lost treatises covered a wide range of topics, including On the Good, On the Soul, On the Gods, and On Happiness, aiming to systematize Platonic doctrine.

As a pivotal early Platonist, Xenocrates played a crucial role in shaping the school's teachings. According to modern scholars, his most lasting contribution was his formal division of philosophy into three parts: Physics, Ethics, and Logic, a framework that became standard in later philosophy. He also developed influential interpretations of Plato's ideas, identifying the Platonic Forms with mathematical numbers and proposing a system of intermediate divine beings, or daemons. His long leadership helped stabilize and define the Academy after Plato's death, influencing later Platonist and Stoic thought.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῶν Πλάτωνος Μαθητῶν · Fragments on Plato's Disciples · 161 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- Ἀλβίνος ὁ Πλατωνικός · Albinus the Platonist · 2 works
- Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης · Alexander of Lycopolis · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον · Anonymous Commentary on Plato · 1 work
- Ἀρίμνηστος · Arimnestus the Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἀττικός · Atticus the Philosopher · 1 work
- Κάσσιος Λογγίνος · Cassius Longinus the Philosopher · 3 works
- Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός · Celsus the Platonist · 1 work
- Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς · Crantor of Soli · 2 works
- Εὐδρόμος · Eudromus the Philosopher · 1 work

- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus II](#) · 1 work
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III](#) · 1 work